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TRANSPORTATION



Tesla finally enters India  
— nine years after Elon  
Musk first teased its  
debut

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expected to open its second store in Delhi later this month as part of its expansion in India.

The automaker also plans to import cars from its facility in Berlin once the India-EU free-trade agreement is signed, TechCrunch has learned.

India is the fourth-largest automotive market after China, the U.S., and Japan — with nearly 6 million vehicles produced annually, according to Indian government data — but the country has a relatively small EV footprint, primarily captured by two-wheelers. The country plans to have 30% of all its automotive sales be electric by 2030, though.

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prices rise on August 7.

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In 2016, Musk announced plans to launch Tesla's Model 3 in India and teased its local Supercharger network. The company even took \$1,000 deposits from its potential Indian customers, which it recently refunded as the launch was uncertain.

Musk has discussed Tesla's plans several times in one-on-one meetings with Prime Minister Narendra

Modi and his senior officials. During the first few years of negotiations, the Indian government sought to convince and even push Tesla to establish its factory in the country to initiate operations.

In 2023, India's commerce minister Piyush Goyal said Tesla was planning to nearly double its component sourcing from India to up to \$1.9 billion that year. Modi and his officials also held conversations with Tesla executives about establishing the company's manufacturing presence in the country. However, Musk remained unconvinced about setting up a local factory anytime soon, sources told TechCrunch.

Tesla has tens of Pune, and does not Prashant operating reported India's

Tesla Co India operations responsible TechCrunch has learned.

In 2024, New Delhi cut import taxes on EVs, allowing Tesla to bring in cars from foreign markets at lower levies. Tesla had long raised concerns about India's 100% import tariffs on cars, but in its April earnings call, Taneja said the company still saw the market as "very hot" despite the hefty duties. Last month, India's minister for Heavy Industries, H.D. Kumaraswamy, confirmed Tesla's plans and stated that the company is "not interested in starting manufacturing in India."

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The India launch comes as the Austin-headquartered company is facing a tough time in major markets, including China, Europe, and the U.S. Local players, including BYD, which also operates in India and is among the handful of electric car companies catering to Indian buyers, are eating into Tesla's market share in China.

Overall, Tesla's China-made EV sales increased 16% year-over-year — which includes both domestic sales in China and exports to Europe and other markets. But the company's Q2 deliveries declined 6.8% year-over-year — the third straight quarterly drop — as local competitors gained market share.

Similarly, Tesla's Q2 deliveries in Europe increased 28% year-over-year in the first six months of 2023, up from a 13% year-over-year increase in the first six months of 2022. Moreover, Tesla's Q2 deliveries in the U.S. fell 6.8% from 443,956 in the second quarter of 2022 to 415,000 in the second quarter of 2023.

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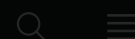
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Tesla is planning to nearly double its component sourcing from India to up to \$1.9 billion this year, the nation's trade minister has said, underscoring the growth of electric-vehicle component manufacturing in the country. But Tesla's long-floated promise of plans to build its own plants in the country remains electric dreams.

Tesla bought \$1 billion of automobile components from India in 2022, and it is targeting to take it to \$1.7-\$1.9 billion this year, India's commerce minister Piyush Goyal said at an auto event in New Delhi on Wednesday.

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"We'll start enjoying the fruits of new technologies, innovation and R&D coming into India. The auto component industry will not only then produce for a larger India demand, but with the same [components] models being sold in the rest of the world, we will also start exporting those components," the minister said.

In June, Tesla CEO Elon Musk [met with Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi](#) in the U.S. Following the meeting, Musk said Tesla was looking to invest in India and establish its local presence in the Indian market "as soon as humanly possible." But he did not provide any timeline, nor investment plan, nor other details.

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(The other plants are in Canada, Germany and the Netherlands). India has been floated as a center for Tesla's EV making since [2021](#), which has played not just into India's fixation on competing with China, but also the country's ambition to be a producer and major customer for the electric vehicle market.

"In many cases, particularly, for example, in taxis, public transport in buses, we already see electric vehicles having become a very compulsive investment case," Goyal said today.

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Tesla's new car sales in Spain fell 36% in April to just 571 vehicles year-over-year, [Reuters reports](#). That slump comes as sales of electric cars made by other brands rose in the Iberian country.

Tesla sales in Spain mirror those in Europe generally, which [plunged](#) in the first four months of the year by 37.2%, even as sales of fully electric vehicles rose 28% on the continent. Some countries

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saw steeper losses than others. For example, Sweden's Tesla sales dropped 81% to their lowest level in nearly three years.

Tesla's poor sales outcome in Europe come as some buyers [protest CEO Elon Musk's](#) swing into [right-wing politics](#) and closeness with President Donald Trump, whose tariffs have resulted in global economic instability. Europeans are also increasingly buying more Chinese EVs, including those from Tesla rival BYD.

Tesla sales have also dropped in the U.S., resulting in soft demand for the automaker's new Model Y, [according to Electrek](#). Tesla has begun offering

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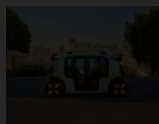
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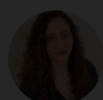
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